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General Comment

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing this public comment regarding Executive Order 14179 (Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence). I oppose the proposals set forth by this executive order; I strongly believe that artificial intelligence technology poses risks to Americans if there are no restrictions or requirements placed upon it. The technology is still too new, and not well-understood by the public; AI technology could create significant issues regarding public trust and safety if it's left unsupervised. Therefore, I highly urge the federal government instead increase the number of restrictions on artificial intelligence technology.

Most crucially, the federal government must restrict the content that may be used to train AI models. As it stands, anything can be used to train an AI model: copyrighted material, personal photos, existing artwork and movies, social media posts, the list goes on and on. Worse, this material can be obtained and used to train models without the original owner's permission. This is a significant violation of our citizens' privacy, and private companies' work. Freedom is one the most important tenets to American society; the public should have the freedom to choose whether they contribute to Artificial Intelligence, rather than have that choice made for them. Private companies should also be confident that they have control over their copyrighted material and intellectual property; an AI model that can create content based off copyrighted material is no better than copyright infringement.

To remedy this, I propose that Congress create policies that give companies and citizens the ability to a) voluntarily opt in to train AI models, b) opt out of AI model training at any time, without restrictions, c) select specifically what material will be sent to train AI models, and d) require private companies to only use material that fits this criteria, nothing more. Additionally, federal policies dedicated to improving transparency on AI-generated content must be passed. Content generated with artificial intelligence must be clearly labelled, and content that falls under this category but is undisclosed must be punished. Citizens must be able to tell what content is created with AI; not only will this ensure that human-created content continues to be seen, but citizens who choose to use AI technology will be able to make more informed decisions on what models to use or train. Congress must also swiftly reintroduce the protections set forth in Executive Order 14110; Americans need to know that, if they choose to, they can use AI technology safely. Furthermore, Congress must continue seeking to create policies that focus on protecting citizens and companies that do not want to train AI models. If we wish to use this technology, we must do whatever it takes to ensure it's used safely and responsibly.

In addition to protecting the freedoms of citizens and companies, the federal government must also invest in combating deepfake technology. Deepfakes are a type of Artificial Intelligence technology that can create realistic depictions of real people—mimicking their voice, appearance, and mannerisms. If left unchecked, this technology could spell disaster for national security. Anyone could create defamatory or incriminating videos of public officials—eroding trust in our democracy, and in other nations. Private citizens could be depicted performing acts they never did, or promoting ideas they do not agree with. Malicious groups and individuals could use this technology to sow violence and distrust in our nation, causing significant harm. If the federal government wishes to continue to be trusted by its citizens, and to ensure national security, it must combat deepfakes and do so swiftly.

To do this, Congress must create policies specifically combating the malicious use of deepfakes. There must be clear and harsh consequences for using deepfakes with the intent to incite violence, defame other people, perform espionage, or otherwise perform harmful, malicious actions. Additionally, the federal government must assist in this process. Whether by existing federal agencies and

commissions, or the creation of new ones, the federal government must take an active role in combatting this serious threat.

I understand the desire behind promoting the development of a new and exciting technology like Artificial Intelligence. However, I believe that supervising and restricting powerful technologies like AI will benefit Americans, not only in the present, but for generations to come. What we do now in AI's early stages will have lasting effects on our future; it's critical that we nurture this new technology, and ensure it grows into something that benefits—not harms—our nation. I hope that Congress and the federal government continue to seek ways to protect Americans' freedoms regarding Artificial Intelligence technologies.